



CARRY THE FLAME!

QUICK START

Learn the game fast - ages 10 and up

Short rules for your first game

End Phase ownership revision - 1 September 2026

Official alpha documentation - use only approved current card wording and published errata.

Start here

Carry The Flame! is a battle card game. Put down Catalysts, use Tricks, and win by dropping the other player's Chi to 0, getting 7 Kills, or getting 7 Extractions.

Your goal: Start at 10,000 Chi. Win by Chi KO, 7 Kills, or 7 Extractions.

1. Build your deck

Deck	How many cards?	Great-card rule
Main Deck	40-60	Up to 5 Great cards.
Fusion Deck	0-15	Up to 5 Great Fusion Catalysts.

That means you can have up to 10 Great cards total: 5 in your Main Deck and 5 Great Fusion Catalysts in your Fusion Deck. Great means the card name has the word Great by itself. Greatness does not count.

2. Set up

1. Shuffle your Main Deck. Draw 5 cards.
2. Both players start with 10,000 Chi.
3. Pick a first player. They draw on turn one, but cannot attack on turn one.

3. Your turn

Order	Do this
Start	Do start-turn effects.
Draw	Draw 1 card. No card to draw? Skip it.
Action	Play Catalysts and Tricks.
Battle	Attack with your Catalysts.
End	Choose one End action or Pass.

4. Play Catalysts

You normally get one Normal Spawn or Set each turn. Level 1-4 needs no Tribute. Level 5-6 needs 1 Tribute. Level 7+ needs 2 Tributes. Tributed cards usually go to Void.

Shotgun Rule: Each time you successfully Special Spawn, your opponent draws 1 card right away. They draw before that new Catalyst's on-Spawn effect. Fusion and Libra are Special Spawns too.

Only five: You can finish only 5 Special Spawns in one turn. A sixth one does not happen. Do not pay for it, and your opponent does not draw.

5. Battle

If this happens	Then this happens
Higher Pressure beats lower Pressure	The loser goes to Void. The loser takes Chi damage equal to the difference.
Equal Pressure	Both go to Void. Each player gets 1 Kill.
Great loses to Counter Pressure	Great goes to Void. Opponent gets 1 Kill. No battle damage from it.
All 5 opponent Catalyst Zones are empty	You may attack directly. They must still be empty when the attack resolves.

6. Tricks and the End

Tricks can help, stop, or change a battle. When players respond, the newest response resolves first. A Counter Trick can only be answered by another Counter Trick.

At End, choose Extract, Rescue, Destroy 1 Trick, or Pass Turn. For a paid choice, send one Catalyst you own and control to the Void. A newly Spawned Catalyst you own may pay. A Catalyst borrowed from your opponent may not pay. Pass Turn is free.

Own it and control it: Your new Catalyst can pay. Your opponent's Catalyst cannot pay, even while you control it.

Remember

- Destroyed, discarded, and Tributed cards go to Void unless a card says something else.
- You may each have 1 Field Trick. Playing a new one replaces your old one, not the other player's.
- Failed or stopped Spawns do not count as Special Spawns and do not make the other player draw.
- If a card uses old or confusing timing words, ask for approved errata. Do not guess.

Your first-game plan: Use one Normal Spawn, save a Trick for a big moment, watch the 5 Special Spawn limit, and count your Great cards before the game begins.